

JOSEPH E. GRANVILLE

1923–

Joseph Granville, the most flamboyant of technical analysts, was known at one time to appear at seminars in costume, accompanied by women in bikinis. His mother was certain he was destined for something special long before he became a celebrity, so she invited the renowned mystic Edgar Cayce to their home. In September 1939, Cayce arrived to uncover young Granville's past life and foretell his future. Granville claimed that Cayce said his "activity will be such that he will never be forgotten!" His father was a more staid man, who was once a banker, but unfortunately had lost the family money in the 1929 crash—an experience that would make Granville an overbearing bear.

Granville served in the Navy during World War II, and was stationed in the Marshall Islands when the atomic bombs were dropped on Japan. After the war, he ran a printing press for \$90 a week, barely able to support his wife and four children. At the time, his hobby was tracking the stamp collecting market and predicting stamp price movements, which ultimately helped him get a job tracking the stock market. In 1957, Granville started writing a daily stock market letter for E. F. Hutton on a trial basis. He found the corporate atmosphere restrictive, however, and in 1963 he quit to start his own newsletter.

After a couple of brilliant calls on market movements, his reputation became so great, that when he predicted a market drop and advised his clients to sell everything and go short in January 1981, he actually created a major sell-off, with the largest trading volume day to date in New York Stock Exchange history. Upset investors asked the Securities and Exchange Commission to investigate, but Granville had done nothing wrong—his newsletter and seminar business boomed. But then he predicted another serious drop in the market in 1982, while others were bullish. The market kept going up, and he lost his following. Granville has since rehabilitated his image, and his newsletter still rates as one of the best. *Market Movements* offers a glimpse into some of Granville's more unorthodox thinking as he equates natural market movements to several famous music pieces.